3.2 BRICKS

Learning Objectives

At the end of this lesson you shall be able to

- Define brick
- Explain the brick size and weight
- Describe the method of manufacturing of bricks
- Classify the bricks
- Explain the properties of good brick
- Know about the hollow block

TCXZSQ

3.2.1 Introduction

Clay bricks were used by humans from very early dates. First, it was used without burning as sundried bricks. Burnt brick was a common building material among the Egyptians. Now a days, they are made from specially selected and matured brick earth. It is used to construct the building because of its good bearing capacity, long life and strength. Bricks are made up of blending a good clay, moulded to a rectangular shape of uniform size, dried and burned. As bricks are in uniform size they can be beautifully laid in masonry work.



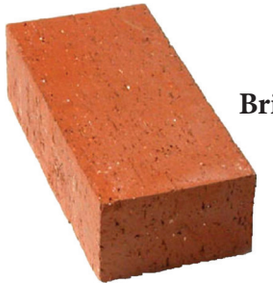
3.2.2 Definition

Bricks are obtained by moulding clay in rectangular moulds, then by drying and burning them. In places where stones are not easily available, bricks are used in construction. These are preferred because of its durability, strength, reliability, lowcast, etc.

DO YOU KNOW?

When and where the first brick was used?

- The earliest bricks were sun dried and made from mud.
- It was used in 8000 BC in southern Turkey around the city of Jericho.
- In Mesopotamia (modern Iraq) the first true arch of sun baked brick was made about 4000 BC.
- Ceramic or fried (burned) bricks were used as early as 3000 BC in early Indus valley cities.



Brick

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